Minutes of the
Special Council Meeting
2025 Capital Budget and 2026-2034 Long Range Capital Forecast; and 2025 Operating Budget
Held in the Council Chambers, Ajax Town Hall and Electronically at 9:00 a.m. on December 13, 2024

Alternative formats available upon request by contacting:
accessibility@ajax.ca or 905-619-2529 ext. 3347

Present:	Chair – Mayor	S. Collier
	Regional Councillors	M. Crawford
		S. Lee
		J. Dies
	Councillors	R. Tyler Morin
		N. Henry
		L. Bower

1. Call to Order & Acknowledgement of Traditional Treaty Lands

Chair – Mayor Collier called the meeting to order at 9:03 a.m. and acknowledged traditional treaty lands.

2. Disclosure of Pecuniary Interest

Mayor Collier declared a pecuniary interest with respect to part-time aquatics wages and benefits (Item 4.4.1), as he has a family member employed by the Town who works in aquatics.

3. Mayor's Opening Comments

Mayor Collier, Budget Chair, provided opening comments, thanked staff for their hard work on the preparation of the 2025 Capital Budget and 2026 **–** 2034 Long Range Capital Forecast and 2025 Operating Budget, and reviewed highlights of the Mayor's proposed 2025 budget.

4. Capital Budget and Operating Budget

4.1 Capital and Operating Budget Presentations

Dianne Valentim, Director of Finance/Treasurer delivered a presentation on the 2025 Capital Budget and 2026 **–** 2034 Long Range Capital Forecast and the 2025 Operating Budget.

Council Members asked questions related to the presentation. D. Valentim responded to questions from Council Members.

Moved by: M. Crawford
Seconded by: S. Lee

That the Capital Budget Presentation and Operating Budget Presentation be received for information.

CARRIED

4.2 Public Comments & Questions

Chair Collier invited comments and questions from the public on the proposed 2025 Capital Budget and 2026 **–** 2034 Long Range Capital Forecast and 2025 Operating Budget.

The following Ajax residents provided comments to Council regarding the proposed 2025 Capital Budget and 2026 **–** 2034 Long Range Capital Forecast and 2025 Operating Budget:

- Chris Baker
- Douglas Glass
- Travis Hill
- Brad Forder
- Sharon Smith
- Angie Papas
- Gordon Glibbery
- Atikur Rahman

Council Members asked questions related to the delegations.

Mayor Collier, D. Valentim, Dave Meredith, Director of Operations & Environmental Services, and Nicole Cooper, Deputy Chief Administrative Officer, responded to questions and comments from the delegates.

On behalf of Council, Mayor Collier thanked each delegate.

Council recessed at 11:32 a.m.

Council resumed at 11:40 a.m.

4.3 **Discussion and Opportunity for Amendments**

Council Members asked questions related to the proposed amendments. Mayor Collier, D. Meredith, Regional Councillor Lee, and Chris Vida, Director of Recreation & Culture, responded to questions from Council Members.

Moved by: S. Collier
Seconded by: S. Lee

Capital Budget Amendments

1. That the EOC Upgrades (25010306) in the amount of $75,000 be removed from 2025.
   Sponsored by Regional Councillor Sterling Lee

2. That the Bike Share Program (25003901) in the amount of $30,000 be removed from 2025.
   Sponsored by Councillor Nancy Henry

3. That the Town Hall Digital Clock Replacement (23002201) in the amount of $20,000 be removed from 2025.
   Sponsored by Councillor Nancy Henry

4. That the Occupancy Sensors (25070908) in the amount of $25,000 be removed from 2025.
   Sponsored by Councillor Nancy Henry

5. That the Parks Two Stream Waste/Recycle (25070005) in the amount of $40,000 be removed from 2025.
   Sponsored by Councillor Nancy Henry

6. That the Harwood Ave M&O – Kerrison to Rossland (25030001) in the amount of $1,573,000 be moved to 2026.
   Sponsored by Councillor Nancy Henry

7. That the Town Hall - Exterior Block Repointing and Sealing (250110104) in the amount of $80,000 be moved to 2026.
   Sponsored by Mayor Shaun Collier

8. That the St. Andrews Gym Roof Replacement (23070702) in the amount of $60,000 be moved to 2026.
   Sponsored by Mayor Shaun Collier

9. That the ACC Rec Master Plan Renovation Design (24000301) in the amount of $100,000 for 2025 be funded through HAF and not the Building Maintenance Reserve.

Sponsored by Mayor Shaun Collier

Operating Budget Amendments

10. That the Christmas in the Village event in the amount of $25,000 be added to 2025.
    Sponsored by Councillor Rob Tyler Morin and Regional Councillor Marilyn Crawford

11. That the Older Adult Recreation Programmer in the amount of $36,600 be removed from 2025.
    Sponsored by Regional Councillor Sterling Lee

12. That an annual payment of $125,000 for Regional Reimbursement for Encampment Cleanup Costs be added 2025.
    Sponsored by Mayor Shaun Collier

13. That the fines and ticket volumes for those Part I Offenses identified to be moved over to AMPS effective May 1, 2025 be increased to generate an additional $50,000 in revenue.
    Sponsored by Mayor Shaun Collier

14. That the fine for the offense of “Park in Fire Route” increase from $100 to $150 in 2025 to generate $60,000 in new revenue.
    Sponsored by Mayor Shaun Collier

15. That the fine for all other parking-related offenses (other than ‘Park in Fire Route’) increase by $10 per offense in 2025 to generate $310,000 in new revenue.
    Sponsored by Mayor Shaun Collier

16. That the Joint Bike Enforcement Project in the amount of $8,000 be removed.
    Sponsored by Mayor Shaun Collier

17. That the staff benefit costs be reduced by an additional $200,000 for 2025.
    Sponsored by Mayor Shaun Collier

18. That the Town develop a Pavement Degradation Structure, like Whitby and Oshawa, with the intent to collect $75,000 in revenue in 2025.
    Sponsored by Mayor Shaun Collier

CARRIED

Moved by: S. Collier
Seconded by: S. Lee

Long Range Forecast Amendments

1. That the St. Andrews Gym Roof Replacement (23070702) in the amount of $640,000 be moved to 2027.
   Sponsored by Mayor Shaun Collier

2. That the ACC Rec Master Plan Renovation Design (24000301) in the amount of $1,500,000 for 2026 be funded through HAF and not the Building Maintenance Reserve.
   Sponsored by Mayor Shaun Collier

3. That the MCC - Mezzanine Gym Storage Room (26070404) in the amount of $100,000 be moved to 2028.
   Sponsored by Councillor Nancy Henry

CARRIED

Council Members asked questions related to the 2025 Capital and Operating Budget including various capital projects and business cases. D. Valentim, C. Vida, Geoff Romanowski, Director of Planning & Development Services, D. Meredith, and Shane Baker, Chief Administrative Officer, responded to questions from Council Members.

Moved by: S. Lee
Seconded by: L. Bower

That staff be directed to include information related to cost savings realized from the Core Services Review in the 2026 budget documents.

CARRIED

4.4 **Council Approval of Items Subject to Mayor Pecuniary Interest**

4.4.1 **Part-time Aquatics Wages and Benefits**

Mayor Collier abstained from voting due to his declared pecuniary interest.

Moved by: S. Lee
Seconded by: N. Henry

That Council approve the budget allocation for part-time aquatics wages in accordance with Section 8(a) of O. Reg 530/22.

CARRIED

5. Confirming By-law

Moved by: J. Dies
Seconded by: L. Bower

That By-law number 90-2024 being a by-law to confirm the proceedings of the Council of the Corporation of the Town of Ajax at its special meeting held on December 13, 2024, be read a first, second and third time and passed.

CARRIED

6. Adjournment (12:45 p.m.)

Moved by: M. Crawford
Seconded by: R. Tyler Morin

That the December 13, 2024 special meeting of the Council of the Town of Ajax be adjourned. (12:45 p.m.)

CARRIED

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Mayor and CEO

_____
Clerk